

Sample Texas Onboarding and Offboarding Policy

Generic employee lifecycle process for a Texas-based employer

Effective date: Sample - update before use

Important demo notice: This is a generic sample document for a Texas-based HR demo. It is not legal advice, does not create an employment contract, and should be reviewed by qualified HR/legal counsel before use by a real employer.

1. Hiring and Onboarding

- New hires must complete all required onboarding steps before or shortly after beginning work, including identity/employment authorization forms, payroll forms, benefit elections, and required policy acknowledgments.
- Managers should provide role expectations, work schedule, system access, job-specific training, and first-week priorities.
- HR should confirm employee classification, pay basis, reporting line, work location, and eligibility for benefits.

2. Employee Classification

- Employees may be classified as exempt or non-exempt under wage and hour rules. Non-exempt employees must track all hours worked and are eligible for overtime when required by law.
- Independent contractors are not employees and should be classified only after review of the working relationship and applicable legal standards.

3. Required Policy Acknowledgments

- Employees should acknowledge receipt of core policies, including equal employment opportunity, anti-harassment, timekeeping, information security, safety, PTO/leave, and code of conduct.
- Acknowledgments confirm receipt and understanding; they do not create a contract.

4. Equipment and Access

- Company property, badges, laptops, software accounts, and confidential information remain company property and must be used only for authorized business purposes.
- IT and HR should maintain a checklist for granting and removing system access.

5. Internal Transfers and Role Changes

- Role changes should be documented in writing, including title, manager, pay rate or salary, classification, effective date, location, and eligibility changes.
- Managers should coordinate with HR before communicating compensation or classification changes.

6. Resignation

- Employees are requested to provide written notice of resignation when possible. The company may accept a resignation immediately or designate a final work date.

- Voluntary separation final pay should be handled by the next regularly scheduled payday, consistent with Texas final pay timing rules.

7. Involuntary Separation

- HR and management should document the reason for involuntary separation, final work date, property return, benefit information, and final pay processing.
- In Texas, when an employee is discharged or otherwise involuntarily separated, final wages are due within six calendar days.

8. Exit Checklist

1. Confirm final work date and separation type.
2. Collect company property and disable system access.
3. Process final wages within the required timeline.
4. Review any written PTO, bonus, commission, or severance policy before deciding whether payment is owed.
5. Provide benefits/COBRA or continuation information when applicable.
6. Document completion of the exit process.

9. Final Pay and Post-Separation Payments

- Final pay should include wages owed for time worked and any other amounts required by written policy, agreement, or applicable law.
- Vacation, PTO, holiday pay, sick leave, parental leave, or severance may be treated as wages if promised in a written policy or agreement. The written policy controls whether payout is owed.
- Deductions from final pay should be reviewed for compliance with applicable wage laws and written authorization requirements.

Reference Notes

- Texas Workforce Commission (TWC), Texas Payday Law and Texas Guidebook for Employers: final pay, fringe benefits, and accrued leave payout guidance.
- U.S. Department of Labor, Wage and Hour Division: Fair Labor Standards Act overtime rules for non-exempt employees.

These references are summarized for demo accuracy. Replace with company-specific legal review before real implementation.